

installed, so you can also add programs using RPM packages.

Games don't seem to figure anywhere in the list of priorities for the creators of SLAX—the same old set of card games on most distributions can be found on SLAX as well. Since it's based on KDE, customising and setting up the

OS is really simple using the KDE Control Center.

When you think of DSL and SLAX as portable operating systems, SLAX doesn't feel like one—it feels more like a full-fledged OS. Anyone wanting the smallest OS with the bare necessities should blindly opt for Damn Small Linux, but if you want anything more, SLAX is your best bet.



The Media Centre

These are distributions meant to take the place of your entertainment centre—playing music and movies and providing some image viewing features, to be specific. The distributions will allow you sit back on your couch and use a remote control or a wireless keyboard to control all your entertainment content.

GeeXboX 1.1

Site: www.geebox.org

Size: 8.8 MB

The distribution we had to try was GeeXboX. The size of the distribution is shocking—with a download size of close to 9 MB, we were wondering if this was even a real distribution! The interface is colourful with a simple menu, and fonts like the ones you would find in cartoonish games like *Worms 3D*.

GeeXboX can play movies and music, and display images and slideshows if you wish. Once completely loaded into memory, the Live CD is ejected, so you can put in your CDs or DVDs. There is no mouse control whatsoever, so you have to depend on the keyboard's direction keys or a remote control.

We had some issues with slideshows switching to next and previous image—we couldn't navigate to them, and had to jump back and forth to the index for this. But movies and music playback worked perfectly—GeeXboX plays back everything from AVIs to MP4s



This is a tiny Linux-based, dedicated media centre

encoded in H.264 or QuickTime. It even played WMV files and Flash video clips—all this through the Live CD, without having to install any third-party codecs or players.

You don't always have to use the Live CD—you also have the option to install GeeXboX on a hard drive, which speeds up its already quick startup time. This distribution is perfect for those who have fairly old machines with some life still in them. Plug in a card with a TV-out function, and you have yourself a media playback centre for free! Check out our October 2006 issue to find out how.

Media Authoring

Content designing and digital media creation has become a common hobby the world over, not to mention a growing business area. Taking advantage of this trend are distributions aimed at all sorts of media creation and editing—perfect if you have multimedia leanings but don't know where to start.

dyne:bolic 2.4.2

Site: www.dynebolic.org

Size: 654MB

Multimedia authoring distributions often conjure up the idea of a software suite that extends into the gigabytes, but dyne:bolic fits on a single CD. The distribution starts up to a pretty-looking interface—

clean with colourful icons. You can customise it by changing to one of the many themes to suit your taste. The interface comes configured with six virtual Desktops—useful when you have plenty going on: drawing, 3D, animations, compositing, communicating with other members in your team, etc. Programs are well-categorised accord-

